

DINESHBHAI MAKWANA, *54*

| BJP | ***Ahmedabad West (SC), Gujarat***

A lawyer by profession, Makwana has been deeply entrenched in the local politics of Ahmedabad for nearly four decades. The former MLA of Sojitra also served as deputy mayor of Ahmedabad city. Known to be an affable and accessible leader, he has patiently worked his way up the BJP ranks and come good at the hustings.



C. ROBERT BRUCE, *62*

| CONGRESS | ***Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu***

The seasoned Congressman and lawyer from Kanniyakumari district finally clinched his chance to contest. Notably, he was the last candidate announced by the party from Tamil Nadu. His nomination held particular significance as it fulfilled the long-standing demand of the Christian Nadar community for representation in Tirunelveli.



A. MANI, *55*

| DMK | ***Dharmapuri, Tamil Nadu***

It baffled many when the DMK fielded lawyer-turned-politician A. Mani instead of incumbent MP Dr D.N.V. Senthilkumar S., who was quite popular. The battle got even tougher when Sowmiya Anbumani, wife of PMK chief Anbumani Ramadoss, entered the fray. In the end though, the senior DMK leader justified his party's trust.



RAJWANT RAWAT

▲ BHUPENDER YADAV, *55*

| BJP | ***Alwar, Rajasthan***

As a Supreme Court lawyer, Yadav seems to have laid enough groundwork to facilitate his foray into politics. He served as the government counsel for both the Liberhan Commission, which probed the 1992 Babri Masjid demolition, and the Justice Wadhwa Commission, which investigated the murder of Australian missionary Graham Staines in Odisha. Now, a two-time Rajya Sabha member, he is a debutant Lok Sabha MP and Union minister, having risen to become one of the most influential BJP leaders of the past decade. Known for his organisational acumen and low profile, he has masterminded the party's electoral strategies for various state assembly elections. And that responsibility has not ceased, tasked as he has been with overseeing the upcoming Maharashtra polls.

R. SUDHA, *46* ▶

| CONGRESS | ***Mayiladuthurai, Tamil Nadu***

The lawyer and ex-chief of the Tamil Nadu Mahila Congress has become the second woman to be elected from Mayiladuthurai, a seat the party has won 10 times. Long journeys are no deterrent—her presence in Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra enough proof of that.





SUKANTA KUMAR PANIGRAHI, *57*

| BJP | ***Kandhamal, Odisha***

An advocate and an agriculturist by profession, Panigrahi brought the combined skills of jurisprudence and rootedness to bear on his poll campaign and defeat the well-known edupreneur and Biju Janata Dal candidate Achyutananda Samanta in Kandhamal, a seat that Naveen Patnaik's party considered its fortress. Of course, there was also the groundwork done by the Sangh Parivar affiliates in the area that was hit by communal riots in 2008, forcing the BJD to part ways with the BJP.



S. MURASOLI, *46*

| DMK | ***Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu***

Courtoom antics he is familiar with. His campaign too was far from run-of-the-mill. At times, the staunch party loyalist would play a round or two of basketball with his electorate; in the final two days of his campaigning, he cycled his way through. Another time, he donned an apron, and proceeded to serve steaming bowls of herbal soup to voters, winning not just their palates but also their support. His victory against his nearest rival from DMDK has helped DMK equal the Congress record of winning nine times from the constituency.

– Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Amarnath K. Menon, Dhaval S. Kulkarni, Rohit Parihar and Jumana Shah